

OREGON CITY COURIER

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A CHRISTMAS SERMON

The Courier has to draw up the slack sometimes and set about serious thinking to determine just why Christmas is. Of course, it is easy for the little toddlers to tell you, but it would give many of the grown folk a job to answer that question.

Christmas is but a mere echo of the day and the season that it was supposed to be. Some brave soul originally meant that we should spend the day in devout worship; an hour from busy lives in which we might perpetuate the name of the Master; a moment in the brief span of years in which we might reverence the hallowed memory of one whose life was given to make our own more livable.

Yet Christmas has come to be anniversary of Christ's birth in name only. It is a day given over to gorging upon the fat of favored lands—a day given to the senseless exchange of senseless gifts. We feast and make merry, we spend our needed dollars for prizes upon the marts, that we may gladden the appetites of friendly folk—and some of us, sometimes, give an hour from the day to worship.

There would be vastly more good done if we all could give our money to the cause of Christianity's progress in the world; if we could devote the same time, the same energy and the same interest to the fulfilling of the Master's desires. But that is not possible, it seems. We are pledged to gift giving and feast making forevermore. And there are scores of reasons why. Yet there appears to be no good and lofty reason, since a complete change cannot be made, why the Christmas season should not be made more nearly as He intended it to be.

Could we not, with profit to ourselves, to our fellows and to the future, give a little more thought on Christmas to the season's hallowed significance? Could we not lend our energies to bringing the kingdom of heaven as close to earth as it ever can be through a devotion, during Christmas, to childhood's kingdom?

It seems that we could more nearly work out the destiny of the Christmas that was intended for us by dividing our attention, if it must be divided at all, between Christ-

mas worship and child happiness. The demand for attention at this season of the older folk has surely taken our minds from the little tots. After all, this Christmas will be better for us and for ours, and it will be better for the world, if we forget ourselves—most of us have had our day—and spend our money, our time and our labors to make the heart of childhood beat faster, to make little faces smile and little souls glad. That is as close to the real Christmas as we can get.

THE GOOD FIGHT

With the year's end casting its shadow before as it advances, Clackamas county has reason to reflect upon the history of the immediate past with a great deal of satisfaction for tasks well done, for works begun, continued and ended in success. The county and its people have been called upon to bear many and unusual burdens during the past year, and it is to the everlasting credit of the county that there has been a hearty response and a concerted action on every hand.

We have been asked to donate unusual sums from our treasure houses; we have been asked to lend our labors to channels which were unheard of in a nation of peaceful souls. And in none of these have we failed. In the big book of patriotism it is recorded that twice Clackamas county oversubscribed on Liberty bond issue; once the county has oversubscribed its quota for half a dozen other things.

All of which but reflects the spirit of America—a spirit that will do much in the coming year to aid in the successful prosecution of the war. But, lest we grow idle, lest we forget that an auspicious start will demand as good an ending, it is timely to point out the enormity of the duties that will confront us in the months to come.

There are other Liberty loans coming; there are other demands to be made upon our time and our labor, upon our patience and upon our allegiance to the cause for which we are sending tens of thousands of our boys to foreign soil. Let us, then, concentrate for a year of activity that will put to shame even the glorious efforts we have made in the past.

Not the least of the demands which should be heeded in our coun-

ty are those looking to the increase of and the conservation of the national food supply. We are peculiarly fitted in this favored land to combat the ravages of privation for our fighting men and for others less favored than we. It is up to every last farmer in Clackamas county to buckle on the harness with the beginning of the new year and set his teeth firmly to the bridle that will steer him into a term of helpfulness to the government, his neighbors and himself. The government needs greater production of food stuffs as greatly as it needs the money we have been hoarding for a rainy day. As tried and proved patriots the people of Clackamas county will come out among the first in response to the plea.

ABNORMAL SITUATION

The federal reserve board reports the labor situation everywhere unsatisfactory, with a marked shortage of men and abnormally high wages. This condition will not rectify itself so long as the draft law unnecessarily withdraws increasing numbers of skilled and mature men from the basic productive industries of the country, says the Spokesman-Review.

The blame does not lie with the exemption boards. Their duties are defined by law and the instructions of the war department. Nor with the war department, for the government must put men in training and must take them from the classes specially defined in the law.

The defect lies in the law itself, which deals very largely with those elements in the country's manhood which had been generally trained for responsible duties and which are now being taken from lines of skilled service, while 2,000,000 or 3,000,000 younger men, partly unemployed and holding jobs of minor responsibility where they are employed, are wholly exempt from the call to training.

The draft law covers those classes who were not younger than 21 nor older than 30 at the time of its adoption. High army officials have asked congress and the administration to amend it to include young men of 19 and 20 and also all those young men who were 20 at the time of the enactment of the law but have now attained the age of 21. Of these three classes there are about 3,000,000 in the United States, and it is closely estimated that about 2,000,000 of them would be physically and otherwise available for training.

By calling them to the colors for training the government could immediately adopt a more liberal policy of exempting older skilled men and men who have assumed bread-winning obligations toward dependent families and relatives.

The need and the wisdom of this action is so obvious that the president ought to urge it upon congress. Delay will be dangerous and costly.

Merry Christmas!

A good bit of Christmas advice: Do your shopping now and send your gifts in time to awaken your friends to the demands of recipro-

Girl messengers are now employed by many of the government departments at Washington. That fact should go well with the several "old women" in congress.

We are not particular what you buy us for Christmas this year, as long as it is in keeping with the spirit of the times—and as long as you buy it in Oregon City.

After all, it is the little things that count. By reducing the size of their samples, wholesale dealers will save his year \$419,500 worth of cloth, representing enough wool to provide uniforms for 67,500 soldiers.

A bill providing for national pro-

hibition during the war was introduced in congress Friday by Senator Shafroth and referred to the agricultural committee. It also would permit commandeering of distilled liquors for government purposes.

M. J. Brown, of the Benton County Courier has seen the real Hawaii. We'd like to ask him if "Hawaiian" music really comes from that island and if the natives thereof really do dance the terrible tarts that are credited to them in pictures and on the stage in this country.

The average newspaper man could collect hush money from the first citizens in any town for holding as such the secrets their good judgment forces them to keep. But when a newspaper man's foot slips you should hear the delighted chorus of I-told-you-sos from the same first citizens.

If you do not really and truly believe there are fools of the first water of fooldom in congress give a look at Robert M. LaFollette, and congratulate yourself that he was not foisted upon us as a president. If Bob LaFollette had been president, Kaiser Wilhelm would be steering America's ship of state today.

Portland was all het up about stories in Collier's magazine lambasting the First Families of that backward village. But the real truth of the matter is not told in the Portland papers. They don't dare tell you that the First Families are holding the town in leash like an infant tied to its mother's apron strings.

Robert M. LaFollette, who disgraces America as a member of the United States senate, said last week that he would have voted against the resolution declaring war on Austria unless certain agreements were included. LaFollette is one of those scoundrels who qualify their patriotism—and let the qualification hang on Germany's side.

The entire Courier force has put its whole interest into this Christmas issue of The Courier, and sends it to more homes in Clackamas county than any other newspaper goes into. The stories you read and the advertisements you study mean that every man and woman in the plant has done his or her best to make YOUR paper interesting to YOU, though it took long hours of sometimes tiresome work to do it. Do you appreciate it?

Sandpoint, Idaho, in 1910 had 2993 souls within its limits. Idaho congressmen are asking for an appropriation of \$30,000 to "complete" work on the Sandpoint postoffice. And then the same congress asks we poor lowly sufferers to buy saving certificates for patriotic reasons. It sometimes almost makes us want to hide our patriotism for fear the light of the inglorious pork barrel will be shed upon it. What human crimes are committed by congressional fools!

The owners of the river steamers Oregon and Pomona say the boats do not get enough patronage to maintain them and they want to sell them to Salem business men. One reason why the boats do not get more business is that the managers have never in any way advertised the freight rates, passenger fares or leaving time of the boats and the

Happy Holidays
Everybody!
And thanks for Remembering
Us this year.

We wish at this time to thank our many friends and loyal customers for the good business we have enjoyed the past year, and to say to you that we are going to give you the same prompt service and courteous treatment the coming year as in the past.

It is our aim to sell you the very best
groceries at all times

WITH BEST WISHES FOR THE HOLIDAY SEASON

The HUB GROCERY CO.

M. E. BUNN

C. H. DICKEY

GOVERNOR OBJECTS

Belief is that County Agent is Needed by Farmers of County

Governor Withycombe has gone on record as being opposed to a movement inaugurated among certain farmers for the abolition of the office of county agent. Approximately 600 farmers in Marion county have signed a petition urging the county court to abolish the office, it is said. Similar petitions have been circulated in Clackamas county.

"In Marion county there appears to be a spirit of more or less antagonism to the employment of an agent," said the governor in a statement issued on the subject. "I believe this is an unfortunate condition, particularly at this time, because there is no question but that an agent can be of great assistance in the production of foodstuffs. The department of agriculture of the government is anxious that every county in the United States have its agricultural agent. A large number of counties in Oregon employ such agents."

RED CROSS SEALS

The Red Cross Christmas seals, little bullets for the war against tuberculosis, are on sale in Oregon City at all drug stores, Bannan's, Lents' confectionery, Dr. Roy Prudden's, H. P. Brightbill, Miller, Parker, Burmeister & Anderson and by Miss Cis B. Pratt in the Dillman & Howland office. Those whose pennies will go to the aid of sufferers from the white plague are asked to make their purchases of seals at any of these stores.

When you send in your order for The Courier and ask for a merchandise order, please tell us what merchant in the city you care to spend it with.

How Leghorns Paid

In the December Farm and Fireside, a writer says: "From 500 White Leghorn fowls I realize enough on egg profits (when feed costs are normal) to net me fair daily working wages throughout the year, in addition to managing my 300-acre grain and live-stock farm in Allamakee county, Iowa. The work of caring for the birds I find a pleasant relaxation from my other farm duties. Much of the work about the poultry houses is done at odd times, when field operations are not pressing. This poultry line has been a part of the regular farm income for five years.

"All eggs are disposed of to a select Chicago trade, at from four to seven cents over the local market price per dozen. The business is all transacted by mail, and shipments of eggs are made by express. "Through the winter months the fowls are kept in two large laying houses—250 in each. These houses are 50x16 feet, with shed roof, 8 feet high in front and 5½ feet in the rear. The walls are made of hollow clay blocks, size 12x8x5 inches, laid edge-wise on a concrete foundation. The surface of the walls is plastered with a cement and sand mixture, and is perfectly smooth. The roof is of tarred preparation, and the floor is of clay."

Dillman & Howland

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Oregon City

Mr. Santa Claus Man

MR. SANTA CLAUS MAN,
won't you please tell
me why

You come with your reindeer
out of the sky?
Do you get from the stars those
bright, shiny toys
That you bring us down here
if we're good little boys?

Mr. Santa Claus Man, won't
you please tell me why
You don't fall straight down
when you come from the
sky?

Do the clouds hold you up or
does old Mr. Sun
Watch over your sleigh till
your journey is done?

Mr. Santa Claus Man, aren't
you ever afraid
Your sleigh won't hold all the
toys you have made?
And aren't you afraid you'll let
some of them fall,
Perhaps my new sled or my
sister's new doll?

Mr. Santa Claus Man, do the
birds ever fly
As far up as you live up in the
sky?
And are you great friends with
the man in the moon?
Does he ride in your sleigh or
isn't there room?

Oh, please, Mr. Santa Claus
Man, let me know
About all these things that
have puzzled me so.
Can't you manage it, somehow,
my mind to relieve,
When you come down our chimney
on next Christmas eve?
—Pittsburgh Press.

You are doing your neighbors and
The Courier an injustice if you do
not tell others about the Christmas
merchandise order given with every
subscription and renewal.